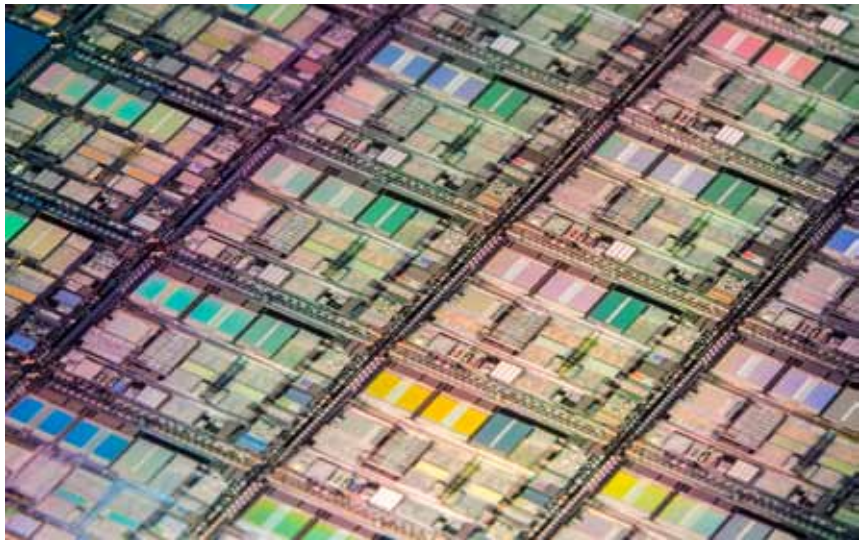


Today, AI doesn't even match 1% of the human brain, so you can imagine how far we have to go. Then we have 5G companies, then we have edge computing—so there are so many new areas which are driven by all the applications in many segments, whether healthcare or industrial or agriculture. All these applications need more and more semiconductor chips to be built,” shares Sambit.

He adds, “I think India can lead in the areas where there are huge demands in the country, particularly in the areas of healthcare, education, and agriculture. These are great opportunities for India to tap into. And to make this successful, people have to innovate, be risk taking, and I think the ecosystem needs to come together more cohesively.

“Here we are looking at one mega cluster like Hsinchu in Taiwan. And having that 500-acre space with water and power, semiconductor resources available there; that is a collaboration that is gonna happen with government of India and state governments like a partnership, but also more of a challenge that whichever state comes out with the most policies that single-window the process which makes it easier for companies. Because these are huge resources and capital intensive decisions that companies are going to take and it is not a decision linked to this policy alone. And this policy is not the only thing that's gonna happen in this sector. The government is also looking at very long term engagement. So, while this 76,000 crore looks like a big number, we cannot stop there. The government is willing to invest more and there's a reason for that.

He adds, “And my request to the whole industry is that if we can have more risk capital, patient capital driving this. Because hardware is difficult. It's not like enterprise or software where you have



CPU silicon wafer seen at 15x magnification under UV lights

immediate wins available, and you can have ten times valuation available in a year or two. Hardware is a game of patience and it requires much deeper collaboration, and we would want more risk capital to get associated with it, and we would definitely see more emergence of electronics and hardware companies also out of India.”

Opportunity for start-ups and MSMEs

A look at how the heavyweights like TSMC, Samsung and others function immediately draws attention to how they have developed an ecosystem where hundreds, and even thousands of small companies are supporting their efforts. It would not be wrong to say that these heavyweights are in turn supporting these hundreds of small companies. These hundreds and thousands of small companies specialise in one thing and pass on that thing to the likes of Samsung. The key to success lies in finding out how these heavyweights support these hundreds of companies.

“Korea, Japan, Taiwan, and China have different systems. The Korean government and the Chinese government support big companies and these big companies support small companies in turn. The

governments in Japan and Taiwan usually support small companies and these small companies in turn support big companies,” says Sung Huk Lee, CEO, Tnvision.

Then there is more than one example of these small companies becoming a heavyweight over time. The biggest of these is TSMC itself. The company started in 1987 and took around eight years to go public. Additionally, there are examples of smaller companies merging with bigger ones. The news of heavyweights acquiring smaller ones is always there on the circuit. These smaller and bigger companies are able to achieve success together because their thinking process is aligned to each other.

“These companies, from a business or a technology point of view, are able to taste success together because they think alike and they think global. Anywhere you go in the world you will definitely hear about the Samsungs and the LGs. In present times you will also hear about the companies that are supporting them. I think the message is to always have a global part in your approach. Whether you are thinking of supporting Tata or Vedanta, you should always think of marketing yourself globally as well. That is